

Social Media Marketing (SMM)

Applied Social Media Marketing Class Plan

Real local businesses | Experiment-driven learning | 10 weekends | 20 x 1-hour classes

Purpose: Students learn the basics of branding and marketing by managing a scoped, approved social media project for an assigned local business. Each week they plan, execute, measure, present, and improve real work.

Schedule	Saturday & Sunday, 1:00-2:00 pm	Duration	10 weeks / 20 live sessions
Core method	Real business work + weekly experiments	Teacher role	Mentor/manager; remote support during the week

How the course works

- Each student is assigned one local business and begins with a short discovery interview, approval boundaries, and baseline audit.
- Learning follows a weekly cycle: observe a business need, form a hypothesis, create and execute, collect evidence, explain the result, and decide the next action.
- Students do the work independently. The teacher gives concise inputs, sets standards, removes blockers, and manages deadlines rather than delivering long lectures.
- Nothing is published, messaged, advertised, or paid for without the business owner's approval. Student work must respect privacy, copyright, brand voice, and platform rules.

Weekend-to-weekday operating rhythm

SATURDAY REVIEW & DEFEND	SUNDAY BUILD & COMMIT	MON-FRI FIELDWORK
Progress evidence; student presentations; questions and defense; manager-style feedback.	Short concept input; guided planning; task assignment; student states the week's commitment.	Students execute with the business, record evidence and metrics, and request remote help when blocked.

Learning outcomes

- Explain a brand's audience, positioning, promise, voice, and visual direction in plain language.
- Connect marketing goals to a simple customer journey, offer, channel, content, call to action, and metric.
- Create basic social content and run at least two small, measurable experiments for the assigned business.
- Use evidence to defend choices, answer questions, accept critique, and recommend a clear next step.

Evidence and assessment

50% weekly business deliverables and experiment evidence | **25%** presentations, defense, and clarity | **15%** reliability, client communication, and deadline management | **10%** final portfolio and business handoff

Weekly proof: task tracker, links/screenshots or drafts, business feedback, metrics, and a short reflection: What happened? Why? What next?

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10-Week / 20-Session Execution Roadmap

WK	FOCUS	SATURDAY 1-2 PM	SUNDAY 1-2 PM	MONDAY-FRIDAY DELIVERABLE
1	Business onboarding & baseline	Course model; meet the business; define scope and approval rules.	Discovery questions; audit channels, audience, offer, and current performance.	Complete interview, consent/scope sheet, baseline screenshots and 3 priority problems.
2	Branding basics	Present baseline; defend the chosen priority problem.	Audience, positioning, brand promise, voice, visual consistency.	Create a one-page brand brief with audience, promise, voice, colors/type, and examples.
3	Marketing basics	Present brand brief; answer client-fit questions.	Customer journey, objectives, offer, channel, CTA, and useful metrics.	Map a simple funnel; write 2 measurable experiment hypotheses and success criteria.
4	Content planning	Pitch hypotheses and receive challenge questions.	Content pillars, formats, calendar, copy structure, and approval workflow.	Build a 1-week calendar and produce 3 approval-ready content drafts.
5	Experiment 1: execute	Content critique; defend creative and CTA choices.	Finalize organic experiment; publishing checklist; evidence capture.	Launch approved Experiment 1; record dates, content, reach, engagement, clicks/leads.
6	Audience communication	Report early signals; explain what is and is not working.	Comments/DMs, response tone, community care, escalation, and privacy.	Use an approved response guide; document interactions and recurring questions.
7	Analytics & iteration	Present Experiment 1 results and defend the conclusion.	Read core metrics; compare baseline; separate signal from assumption.	Write a 1-page experiment review and recommend one evidence-based change.
8	Experiment 2: improve	Pitch the change and expected result.	Design a controlled improvement: hook, format, timing, offer, CTA, or audience.	Launch approved Experiment 2; keep other variables stable where practical; log results.
9	Micro-campaign & reporting	Compare experiments; explain trade-offs and limits.	Combine brand, content, CTA, and measurement into a short campaign plan.	Run/prepare an approved 1-week micro-campaign and draft a client-facing report.
10	Final defense & handoff	Final presentation: problem, actions, evidence, learning, recommendation.	Peer/client questions; revise portfolio; plan a sustainable next 30 days.	Deliver final portfolio, asset folder, metrics summary, recommendations, and client handoff.

Completion standard: Every student must show approved real-business work, evidence from two experiments, reflective decisions, a clear verbal defense, and a usable handoff for the business.